

Logical Reasoning

Time—35 minutes

25 Questions

Directions: Each question in this section is based on the reasoning presented in a brief passage. In answering the questions, you should not make assumptions that are by commonsense standards implausible, superfluous, or incompatible with the passage. For some questions, more than one of the choices could conceivably answer the question. However, you are to choose the best answer; that is, choose the response that most accurately and completely answers the question and mark that response on your answer sheet.

1. Columnist: The dangers of drinking are greatly exaggerated in the medical press. We are always hearing about the extent to which alcohol can shorten one's life, but my grandfather drank heavily his entire life and lived to be 95.

The reasoning in the columnist's argument is most vulnerable to criticism on the grounds that the argument

- (A) does not address moral objections to alcohol consumption
- (B) fails to consider factors other than alcohol consumption that can shorten one's life
- (C) only addresses the length of a life, and not the quality of that life
- (D) confuses the cause of a phenomenon with an effect of that phenomenon
- (E) relies merely on anecdotal evidence to challenge a general claim

2. Some have argued that using food crops to produce fuel represents an unprecedented attack on the food supply. It seems immoral to divert crops from the food supply while there is a need for food. But we currently divert crops from the human food supply to feed livestock. So the diversion of food to fuel is not actually a radical break with traditional practices.

The argument proceeds by

- (A) arguing that the bad consequences of a practice are outweighed by the good consequences of that practice
- (B) countering the charge that a practice has a bad consequence by trying to show that the practice does not actually have that consequence
- (C) rebutting a charge that a practice is radical by contending that the practice is analogous with an existing one
- (D) rejecting the charge that a practice is immoral by trying to undercut the moral foundation of the charge
- (E) supporting a moral objection to a practice by trying to show that the practice is actually different from practices that might seem similar

3. Hernandez: Celebrities' public pronouncements can warp a debate because people grant more weight to celebrities' opinions than to ordinary people's. For that reason, celebrities should avoid talking publicly about controversial issues on which they have no expertise.

Liu: But celebrities are full members of their communities. It is not their fault if people give their opinions more credence than they should. So it is absurd that they should not feel free to join controversial debates.

Hernandez and Liu disagree with each other about which one of the following?

- (A) People grant more weight to celebrities' opinions than to ordinary people's.
- (B) Celebrities should avoid talking publicly about controversial issues on which they have no expertise.
- (C) Celebrities' pronouncements on controversial issues can warp debates on those issues.
- (D) The public should disregard what celebrities say about controversial issues.
- (E) Celebrities are responsible for the fact that people give their opinions more credence than they should.

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4. A process of extracting caffeine from coffee without seriously compromising the coffee's taste was introduced a number of years ago. When this decaffeinated coffee first came on the market, however, many coffee drinkers reported that it tasted rather bad.

Which one of the following, if true, most helps to resolve the apparent discrepancy in the statements above?

- (A) The percentage of coffee drinkers who drink only decaffeinated coffee is much larger today than it was at the time the process was introduced.
- (B) Many coffee drinkers would not drink decaffeinated coffee even if they believed that it tasted as good as regular coffee.
- (C) The taste of any kind of coffee can be affected by the foods that are consumed along with it.
- (D) Coffee that is decaffeinated through this process generally costs more than regular coffee.
- (E) During the years in which the process was introduced, coffee processors used only low-quality coffee beans for their decaffeinated products.

5. Researchers gave each of eighteen subjects a playing card, then offered them money to lie to a computer about the identity of the card while undergoing a scan by functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI). When subjects lied, the scans revealed increased activity in several regions of the brain known to be stimulated by stress. This supports the idea that fMRI can eventually form the basis of an effective lie detector.

Which one of the following would, if true, most weaken the argument above?

- (A) Existing methods of lie detection, including the polygraph, have not been shown to be reliable.
- (B) The majority of people regard lying in an experimental situation as unethical.
- (C) The amount of stress that accompanies lying varies widely from person to person and is also affected by the circumstances in which the lie is told.
- (D) Telling a carefully planned lie causes less stress than telling a lie spontaneously.
- (E) Stress reactions in the brains of subjects who are being truthful are similar to those that occur in the brains of subjects who are lying.

6. Prominent government officials have denied that their policies have produced serious environmental degradation. But the facts show otherwise. Last year, at the urging of certain mining companies, the government repealed a long-standing provision prohibiting the dumping of mining wastes into streams. Since that time, hundreds of miles of vital streams have been buried under bulldozed mining wastes.

The argument relies on which one of the following assumptions?

- (A) Without the urging of certain mining companies, the government would not have lifted the ban on dumping mining wastes into streams.
- (B) The prominent government officials who deny that government policies have produced serious environmental degradation do not really believe what they are claiming.
- (C) The mining companies that urged repeal of the ban on dumping mining wastes in streams were among those that buried hundreds of miles of streams under mining wastes.
- (D) The government is generally more responsive to pressures from the mining industry than from environmentalists.
- (E) If the ban on dumping mining wastes in streams had not been repealed, considerably less mining waste would have found its way into streams.

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Logical Reasoning

7. Critic: It generally holds true of concert pianists that the more famous the musician, the greater the pleasure of his or her audience. In my view, this is only fair and should give no cause for cynicism about the ability of audiences to distinguish good playing from bad.

Which one of the following, if true, most strongly supports the critic's view?

- (A) The fame of concert pianists usually reflects their talent as musicians.
- (B) Some of the finest concert pianists are unknown to the general public.
- (C) In general, the more famous the pianist, the larger the audiences that he or she can draw.
- (D) Even the finest concert pianists cannot play consistently well at every performance.
- (E) The very best concert pianists often perform works that are difficult for audiences to appreciate.

8. Scientists found the remains of several species of mites trapped in rocks in a high-altitude cave. Radioactive dating shows that the mites were trapped about 2,000 years ago. The mite species in the rocks no longer live in the vicinity of the cave, but they are found a few miles away in a cooler area. Therefore, the area around the cave was probably cooler 2,000 years ago, since _____.

The conclusion of the argument is most strongly supported if which one of the following completes the passage?

- (A) the mite species found in the rocks can only survive in very specific climates
- (B) the cooler area a few miles away from the cave also has a somewhat wetter climate
- (C) the mite species that were trapped in the rocks did not live in the vicinity of the cave much earlier than 2,000 years ago
- (D) the mite species found in the rocks only live at high altitudes
- (E) there are fewer mite species living in the vicinity of the cave today than there were 2,000 years ago

9. Market studies confirm that consumers shopping for automobiles primarily seek those that are most reliable. An automobile is reliable if it very rarely breaks down and it does not require significantly more maintenance than average. Strangely enough, however, some of the most reliable models do not sell well with those who say they care most about reliability.

Which one of the following, if true, most helps to resolve the apparent discrepancy in the information above?

- (A) Consumers who are shopping for an automobile claim to care more about reliability than about fuel efficiency.
- (B) Consumers often choose automobile models based on a reputation for reliability, and reputations can be out of date.
- (C) Some owners of reliable automobiles are reluctant to trade them in for newer vehicles and tend to hold on to them for the life of the automobile.
- (D) Some automobile models that have been shown to require a lot of maintenance very rarely break down.
- (E) Some of the most stylish automobiles are some of the most unreliable.

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10. A recent study found that most individuals believe that they sleep less than most other people. However, it is obviously not possible that most people sleep less than most other people. Therefore, _____.

Which one of the following most logically completes the argument?

- (A) some people believe things that could not possibly be true even in principle
- (B) most people are not aware of how much they sleep
- (C) most people underestimate how much they sleep in comparison to others
- (D) most people think that they do not sleep as much as they should
- (E) some people incorrectly believe that they sleep less than most other people

11. Ross: Many governments have attempted to regulate strictly or even outlaw theater because of its subversive power. Such strategies have rarely succeeded, probably because people strongly desire theater for entertainment and dramatists always find subtle ways to criticize authorities who treat them harshly. Thus, since dramatists will not criticize governments of which they are honored employees, an effective strategy for controlling theater and satisfying the public is to make dramatists and performers honored employees of the government.

Which one of the following, if true, would most weaken Ross's argument?

- (A) Few governments are willing to shoulder the expense of employing dramatists and performers.
- (B) Even when completely unregulated, theater rarely leads to the overthrow of a government.
- (C) Some dramatists criticize their governments even though those governments do not treat them harshly.
- (D) Most theatrical productions neither criticize government nor support it.
- (E) The public generally dislikes plays written or performed by government employees.

12. Many hikers now carry cell phones so they can call for emergency assistance from remote areas. Many also use their cell phones to call wildlife offices when they see poachers breaking game laws, enabling wildlife agents to reach the scene before the lawbreakers leave. Poachers, however, avoid areas they know to be frequented by hikers.

Which one of the following is most strongly supported by the information above?

- (A) Most hikers can afford cell phones.
- (B) Poaching has decreased as cell phone use has increased.
- (C) Wildlife agents do not usually carry cell phones.
- (D) Some hikers hike in areas that are not known by poachers to be frequented by hikers.
- (E) Cell phones are becoming one of the most effective tools in the effort to protect wildlife from poachers.

13. A cognitive psychologist has claimed that intelligence is the ability to figure out how things work in order to overcome obstacles. If, however, we were to become convinced that a particular being had acquired an understanding of how things work, we would certainly not deny that that being possessed intelligence, even if we were sure that its acquisition of this understanding was not prompted by the desire to overcome some specific obstacle. Clearly, then, the cognitive psychologist's definition is inadequate.

In the passage the author does which one of the following?

- (A) rejects a definition on the grounds that the terms employed in the definition would make it impractical to determine which cases it covers
- (B) uses a hypothetical application of a definition to argue that the definition would have unacceptably counterintuitive consequences
- (C) argues that a proposed definition does not specify the meaning of the concept being defined narrowly enough for the definition to be applied
- (D) rejects a definition on the grounds that if it were accepted as correct, the term being defined would apply to things to which it normally does not apply
- (E) argues against a proposed definition on the grounds that those who support it do so at least partly on an inappropriate appeal to authority

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Logical Reasoning

14. Environmentalist: The adoption of genetically engineered crops in agriculture is moving so rapidly and is monitored so loosely that it poses a significant risk of damaging sensitive ecosystems. One such crop had already been widely planted when a study found that it could threaten monarch butterflies. Therefore, before any new genetically engineered crop is put into agricultural production, rigorous testing of its safety should be required.

Which one of the following principles, if valid, most helps to justify the environmentalist's reasoning?

- (A) A genetically engineered crop should not be put into agricultural production if rigorous testing has shown it to be risky.
- (B) If a crop has no potential for posing environmental risks, it may be put into agricultural production without testing of its safety.
- (C) No crop that might present risks to the environment should be allowed into agricultural production unless its safety has been thoroughly tested.
- (D) If rigorous testing of any genetically engineered crop that is in agricultural production shows that that crop poses environmental risks, production of that crop should be discontinued.
- (E) If rigorous studies do not find evidence that a crop would present risks if it is brought into agricultural production, no further testing of that crop's safety is required.

15. Faculty member: The university's financially minded president holds that some academic programs should be eliminated because they do not serve student demands. According to him, the university is a business and the students are consumers, and it is the responsibility of any business to satisfy consumer demand. But the education of students is not analogous to the providing of consumer goods. Therefore, the president is mistaken in claiming that academic programs should be tailored to suit student demand.

The faculty member's argument is most vulnerable to the criticism that it

- (A) argues for a view without showing that an argument against that view fails
- (B) appeals to popular opinion to justify a conclusion
- (C) treats merely analogous things as identical
- (D) improperly attacks the university president's moral character
- (E) rejects a view on the grounds that someone has given inadequate reasons for accepting that view

16. A recent study carefully tracked the specific behaviors of five East African chimpanzee groups of one subspecies, and of two West African groups of another subspecies, in activities such as grooming and foraging. The study found that one of the East African groups was behaviorally more similar to the West African groups than to the other East African groups. It is therefore likely that these behaviors are determined by cultural factors rather than by genetics.

Which one of the following, if true, provides the most support for the argument?

- (A) Chimpanzees sometimes copy the behavior of other chimpanzees, whether or not they are closely related genetically.
- (B) Chimpanzees that are new to a group sometimes bring with them new behaviors as well as new genetic characteristics.
- (C) The chimpanzee groups studied face different environmental challenges due to their different locations in Africa.
- (D) The behavioral differences in the chimpanzee groups studied are sufficient to make each group recognizably distinct from all the others.
- (E) Of the chimpanzee groups studied, the five East African groups live in closer proximity to each other than do the two West African groups.

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17. Essayist: It would be wrong to defend current testing procedures for new medications simply by appealing to the fact that test subjects are volunteers who are both apprised of and compensated for the risks involved. For while it is not wrong to pay people to do something if they are freely choosing to do it, the same cannot be said if the choice is made under duress.

Which one of the following is an assumption required by the essayist's argument?

- (A) Possessing information about the possible consequences of the choices one makes does not ensure that one's choices are free.
- (B) No transaction can be justified merely on the grounds that those participating in the transaction do so voluntarily.
- (C) Anyone who acts without complete freedom is acting under some form of externally imposed duress.
- (D) There is nothing wrong with accepting money for putting oneself at risk.
- (E) People should be permitted to perform any action so long as that action is freely chosen.

18. Putting a tap in a healthy maple that has a trunk 12 or more inches in diameter will not harm the tree. Silver maples, red maples, and Manitoba maples can all be tapped for making maple syrup. The sugar maple, however, is best for syrup making, because of all the maples its sap has the highest concentration of sugar.

If the statements above are true, which one of the following must also be true?

- (A) A maple whose trunk is more than 12 inches in diameter is unhealthy if it is harmed by tapping.
- (B) The healthiest maple trees are usually those with the largest trunks.
- (C) A maple tree that has been harmed will produce very little sap.
- (D) Putting a tap into an unhealthy maple tree that is less than 12 inches in diameter will harm it.
- (E) The maple trees most commonly used for making syrup are sugar maples.

19. Company spokesperson: Although our products are the most expensive in our industry, they are also the best available. After all, consider any less expensive product made by one of our competitors. If it were as good as, or better than, our product, it would cost as much, or more.

The reasoning in the company spokesperson's argument is flawed in that the argument

- (A) contains a premise that presupposes the truth of the conclusion
- (B) fails to make a needed distinction between the best product currently available and the best product that could be produced
- (C) treats a cause of a product being the most expensive as an effect of its being the most expensive
- (D) presumes that because something is true of each of a company's products it is also true of the company as a whole
- (E) bases a conclusion on claims that are inconsistent with each other

20. It should be illegal to patent an organism's genes, for a person should not be regarded as the inventor of something he or she merely discovered. Moreover, exploitation of genetic information for profit is selfish and irresponsible.

Which one of the following principles, if valid, most helps to justify the argument?

- (A) Any person who exploits genetic information for profit should be considered selfish.
- (B) Discovering something should not entitle one to patent it.
- (C) Discovering something does not always constitute inventing it.
- (D) No person should be allowed to profit from something that was invented by another person.
- (E) A person or corporation who invents something should be entitled to patent it.

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Logical Reasoning

21. Professor O'Brien: Any of my students who heard Mercado's lecture from the beginning would have thought it was fascinating, and I know that some of my students did think it was fascinating, so some of my students must have heard it from the beginning.

Professor O'Brien's argument does not follow logically from its premises because of the possibility that

- (A) some of Professor O'Brien's students are very interested in Mercado's work but were unable to attend the lecture
- (B) many people who are not Professor O'Brien's students did not think that the lecture was fascinating, even though they heard it from the beginning
- (C) some of Professor O'Brien's students were a few minutes late for the lecture and did not find the lecture fascinating
- (D) no one who heard the lecture from the beginning and thought that it was fascinating was one of Professor O'Brien's students
- (E) not everyone who arrived at the lecture on time was able to hear the entire lecture because of disruptions caused by those who were late in arriving

22. Some moral virtues, such as honesty, tend to benefit one who has them; others, such as generosity, do not. A personal characteristic is not a moral virtue if it tends to be detrimental to other people.

If the statements above are true, which one of the following must also be true?

- (A) A person totally lacking in moral virtue will tend not to have characteristics that benefit others.
- (B) Being honest tends not to be detrimental to other people.
- (C) A morally virtuous person tends to be a greater benefit to other people than a person who is not morally virtuous.
- (D) Being generous tends to be to one's own detriment but not to the detriment of others.
- (E) If a personal characteristic that one has tends to benefit others, then that personal characteristic is a moral virtue.

23. During last year's flu season no one who was vaccinated contracted the flu. This year every student at South High School has been vaccinated. So this flu season none of the students at South High School will contract the flu.

Which one of the following arguments is most similar in its reasoning to the argument above?

- (A) No camper who used insect repellent last month was disturbed by mosquitoes. Since everyone in our campsite has applied insect repellent tonight, none of us will be disturbed by mosquitoes tonight.
- (B) Last year, Marie purchased a car that had been well maintained. Since Marie will certainly continue to maintain the car this year, the car is unlikely to have mechanical problems this year.
- (C) Last year, no student with perfect attendance failed a class, and all students in advanced history had perfect attendance. So no student in advanced history last year failed the class.
- (D) All the fruit we purchased yesterday was fresh. All the fruit we bought yesterday is in the refrigerator. Therefore, all the fruit in the refrigerator is fresh.
- (E) No sparrow eats seeds with hard shells. All seeds of this tree have hard shells. So no sparrow will eat the seeds of this tree.

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24. Advertising agencies are often wrongly criticized for causing people to desire, and thus purchase, products they do not really need. People actually buy what they buy mainly because they believe the product will satisfy their desires—a belief that, admittedly, it is the purpose of advertising agencies to induce. It is clear then that the desires that people believe products will satisfy _____.

Which one of the following most logically completes the argument?

- (A) can be classified as needs if they actually prompt people to make a purchase
- (B) are created by false, but not by true, advertising claims
- (C) will rarely be satisfied by the purchases they prompt
- (D) are exploited rather than created by advertisers
- (E) are generally what induce people to believe claims made by advertisers

25. Artist: I have never won a prize at the Art Competition, even though several of my submitted paintings have received widespread recognition and have sold thousands of copies as posters. I know six other popular artists who have submitted works to that competition and fared no better. Thus, winning the Art Competition proves that an artist is no good.

The pattern of flawed reasoning in which one of the following arguments most closely resembles that in the artist's argument?

- (A) Researcher: I have never won a prize at the Science Competition, although I have obtained patents for several of my inventions and they have been extremely lucrative. Other scientists have had similar experiences. Therefore, the judges are using some criterion other than marketability to judge the inventions.
- (B) Cook: I always win a prize at the Cooking Competition, even though my entries are regarded by the general public as unusual and unappealing. Other cooks have reported similar experiences. Thus, winning proves that one's culinary creation is not to most people's taste.
- (C) Professor: The same essays that have won nothing in some years at the Philosophical Essay Competition have won the grand prize in other years. So the essays are not judged entirely on quality.
- (D) Student: The student government never takes my proposals seriously, even when these proposals have the support of most students. Others have also introduced widely supported proposals, but the student government has not seriously considered theirs either. So the student government takes only bad proposals seriously.
- (E) Travel agent: When I do my most creative and dedicated work, the airlines reduce my commissions. And when I do rushed work, they send me fruit baskets in gratitude. I conclude that airlines want to discourage good ideas and hard work.

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IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION ONLY.
DO NOT WORK ON ANY OTHER SECTION IN THE TEST.



**February 2024 LSAT Answer Key
Form LTZD01**

Question	Analytical Reasoning	Logical Reasoning	Reading Comprehension
1	C	E	E
2	A	C	D
3	E	B	B
4	B	E	D
5	D	E	B
6	E	E	C
7	A	A	B
8	C	A	A
9	C	B	E
10	B	E	D
11	C	E	C
12	B	D	C
13	E	B	E
14	D	C	C
15	A	E	D
16	B	A	A
17	D	A	C
18	C	A	B
19	D	A	E
20	B	B	A
21	B	D	A
22	A	B	C
23	C	A	C
24		D	A
25		D	B
26			A
27			C